

COMPANY OVERVIEW

Sanofi US Services, Inc. is a Large Private Subsidiary based in Morristown, New Jersey [1, 2]. They perform biopharmaceutical research, molecular engineering, and therapeutic manufacturing for global patient demographics, managing chronic, immunological, and rare medical conditions [2]. This firm offers a potential partnership because its widespread integration of large language models for biological discovery, automated factory digital twins, and scalable clinical trial optimizations aligns completely with UNC's core competencies in biomedical informatics, machine learning workflows, and healthcare data systems [7, 8].

BASIC COMPANY INFORMATION

- **Name & Location:** Sanofi US Services, Inc., Bridgewater, NJ [1, 2]
- **Website URL:** sanofi.us/en [1, 2]
- **Company Type:** Private Subsidiary
- **IPO:** No (Parent corporation Sanofi SA trades publicly on the NYSE under SNY) [2, 5]
- **Large:** 750+ (15,000 workers within the domestic United States workforce) [1, 2, 5]

UNC CONNECTION

Dr. Christopher Gagliardi — Sanofi

- Dr. Christopher Gagliardi serves as a Principal at Sanofi Ventures, the corporate venture capital arm of global pharmaceutical giant Sanofi [11, 13].
- Serves as a Board Member at AdvanCell Isotopes, i2O Therapeutics, Minervax, and Sudo Bio, and acts as a Board Observer for Matchpoint Therapeutics [11].
- Serves on the board of computational discovery firm QuantX [11, 12].
- Dr. Gagliardi is a strong avenue for partnership because he sits at the intersection of Sanofi's venture capital arm and early-stage biotech, and holds a direct UNC degree, making outreach natural and credible [11].

Mr. Pradeep Mangalath — Sanofi

- Mr. Pradeep Mangalath serves as the Senior Director of Commercial Transformation for Specialty Care North America and Head of Portfolio Management for Digital Healthcare at Sanofi [14, 15].
- Co-founded and serves as COO/CTO of Reboot Rx (a non-profit technology startup utilizing AI for cancer drug repurposing) and previously consulted at Deloitte on digital strategy and M&A [14].

TALKING POINTS

SECTION 1: Sanofi Organizational Context

- Use these as opening framing points to demonstrate institutional knowledge before pivoting to partnership specifics.

- **Financial Momentum:** Sanofi reported €10.5bn in Q1 2026 net sales, up 13.6% year-on-year, driven by Dupixent (+30.8%) and a 49.6% surge in pharma launches. The company reaffirmed full-year guidance of high single-digit sales growth.
- **Rare Disease Growth Engine:** Rare disease revenues reached €1.75bn in Q1 2026 (+20.1%), with 49% of those sales coming from newly launched products. Ayvakit (KIT inhibitor) and ALTUVIIIO (haemophilia A) are the primary growth drivers.
- **AI as a Core R&D Strategy:** Sanofi's proprietary AI infrastructure — including the CodonBERT mRNA language model (trained on 10M sequences), the Expert AI target discovery engine, and the internal 'plai' workflow tool — has delivered 7 novel validated drug targets in a single year and cut vaccine design timelines by 50%. The company targets up to one year of timeline reduction per molecule.
- **External Innovation Model:** Sanofi's Q1 2026 licensing appendix shows active partnerships with Recursion (AI-driven small molecule discovery), Kymera (protein degraders), Nurix (STAT6 degrader), and Scribe Tx (CRISPR-associated programs) — confirming a clear appetite for AI-native and technology-platform academic/biotech partnerships.

SECTION 2: Pipeline Alignment with UNC Research

- The following talking points pair specific Sanofi pipeline programs with named UNC faculty or centers. Each is individually verifiable.
- **Kinase Inhibitors / KIT Program → Dr. Eileen Kennedy**
- Sanofi's elenestininib (D816V-mutated KIT inhibitor) is in Phase 3 for systemic mastocytosis, with Ayvakit (avapritinib, a related KIT/PDGFRα inhibitor) generating €177m in Q1 2026 revenue. UNC recently recruited Dr. Eileen Kennedy as Chair of Chemical Biology & Medicinal Chemistry — she brings a distinguished record specifically in kinase research. This is a direct faculty-to-pipeline alignment.
- **AI Drug Repurposing → Prof. Alex Tropsha / MATRIX Project**
- Sanofi is actively licensing AI-driven drug discovery platforms (Recursion, Insilico Medicine). UNC Distinguished Professor Alex Tropsha leads the MATRIX Project at RENCI, using biomedical knowledge graphs and machine learning to identify drug-disease connections among existing compounds — the exact same class of capability Sanofi pays Recursion to provide. The MATRIX work contributed to the 2025 TIME Best Inventions list (Every Cure). The open-source DELi platform from UNC's Center for Integrative Chemical Biology further democratizes this approach.
- **Neurology / Alzheimer's → Dr. Alison Axtman / SGC-UNC**
- Sanofi has an active Phase 2 asset (SAR448851, TREM2 agonist) in Alzheimer's disease. UNC's Structural Genomics Consortium (SGC-UNC) is a funded partner in the TREAT-AD consortium (Target Enablement to Accelerate Therapy Development for Alzheimer's Disease) — operating in the same upstream target space. Dr. Axtman, the inaugural Maureen Daly Blouin Distinguished Scholar in Open Science Drug Discovery at SGC-UNC, leads neurodegenerative disease work including Alzheimer's and ALS.
- **Oncology / Undruggable Targets → Dr. Lindsey James**
- Sanofi's oncology pipeline includes programs targeting CEACAM5 (ADC, colorectal cancer) and GPRC5D (myeloma), alongside exploration of novel molecular targets. UNC Associate Professor Lindsey James was awarded the Hettleman Prize for creating specialized molecules targeting gene-controlling proteins long considered 'undruggable' — with direct applications to cancer treatment and HIV. This positions UNC as a source of novel oncology targets at the discovery stage Sanofi is actively seeking to replenish.

- **Lysosomal Storage Diseases → Chemical Biology & Medicinal Chemistry Division**
- Sanofi's venglustat (oral GCS inhibitor) has Phase 3 programs in both Gaucher disease type 3 (primary endpoint met) and Fabry disease (ongoing CARAT trial), and received US Breakthrough Therapy designation for GD3. UNC's Chemical Biology & Medicinal Chemistry division — now led by Dr. Kennedy — has expertise in small molecule enzyme pathway modulation that is directly relevant to this therapeutic class.
- **mRNA Vaccines → UNC Vaccine Sciences / DeSilva Lab**
- Sanofi's vaccine pipeline now includes mRNA programs for acne (SP0268, Phase 2), chlamydia (SP0269, Phase 1), RSV+HMPV combinations (SP0256, Phase 2), and flu H5 pandemic (SP0289, Phase 2) — all built on the CodonBERT mRNA design platform. UNC's Dr. Aravinda DeSilva has received multi-year NIAID funding (R01AI125198, 2016-2020) for preclinical assay work on dengue vaccine efficacy, a disease area where Sanofi has a marketed product (Dengvaxia/Sanofi Pasteur). This positions UNC as a credible academic partner for translational vaccine validation.
- **Dupixent Next-Generation Strategy → Immunology Research**
- Sanofi's investor deck explicitly frames a three-part Dupixent strategy: Defend (patents to 2045), Extend (quarterly dosing, co-formulation studies starting H2 2026), and Innovate ('potential to pursue additional molecules'). This 'Innovate' pillar is a formal signal that Sanofi is actively seeking next-generation immunology science. UNC's SGC-UNC chemical probe work on immune pathway targets, and the broader immunology research base at Eshelman, is a natural fit for sponsored research aimed at this pipeline gap.

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